

Zhiwei Li

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EDUCATION

Duke University & Duke Kunshan University Dual Degree (Class of 2028)

BS: Interdisciplinary Studies (Subplans: Applied Math & Computational Science; Computer Science), Duke University; Applied Math & Computational Science; Computer Science (Duke Kunshan University)

- GPA: 3.83/4.00; Dean's List Fall 2024, Dean's List Spring 2025, Dean's List Fall 2025
- Courses: Programming and Database, Machine Learning, Probability and Statistics, Linear Algebra, Calculus

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Leader in Edge Intelligence Lab 08/2025-Present
ChatDKU Project (Supervisor: Bing Luo, Assistant Professor of Data and Computational Science, Cambridge University Clare Hall Visiting Fellowship, IEEE Senior Committee) Kunshan, China

- Led feature development, including SQL Agent extensions, complex retrieval pipeline design, and implementation of state-of-the-art RAG methodologies; built retrieval pipelines using DSPy and LlamaIndex.
- Maintain lab server backend and infrastructure through performance monitoring, system diagnostics, and management of Django services and databases (Redis, Chroma, PGSQL) to ensure stable system operation.
- Advanced engineering best practices through modular refactoring, CI workflows, and Git-based version control; supporting 50+ daily active users and improving response accuracy by 35% in real-world usage.

U-Corp Program at DKU (Collaborator: Eric Liu, CEO of Philosophie AI) 09/2024-07/2025
Research Topic: Mapping the Future of AI Education Kunshan, China

- As Research team leader, conducted comprehensive literature reviews, designed surveys to gather data, and facilitated communication within the team to ensure smooth collaboration.
- Gained valuable experience in research methodology, data collection, and effective teamwork, while enhancing my ability to synthesize information and communicate research findings.

International Genetically Engineered Machine Competition (iGEM) – Silver Medal 11/2024-11/2025
Research Team Member (Supervisor: Linfeng Huang, Associate Professor of Biology) Kunshan, China

- Conducted thorough literature reviews to support biological modeling efforts and applied biology modeling techniques to understand disease mechanisms.
- Created impactful graphics to represent complex biological research, enhancing communication of findings.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HP 12/2025-02/2026
Data Analyst Intern Beijing, China

- Designed and implemented data automation programs to streamline repetitive data processing tasks, significantly reducing manual workload for staff and improving operational efficiency and reliability.
- Supported supplies business data management by organizing, cleaning, and maintaining operational datasets to ensure data accuracy, consistency, and usability.
- Analyzed end-to-end supplies management workflows to identify inefficiencies and recurring pain points, translating business requirements into actionable technical solutions.

Teaching Assistant of Calculus 08/2025-12/2025
Student Worker (Supervisor: Zhenghui Huo, Assistant Professor of Mathematics) Kunshan, China

- Led weekly sessions and individualized academic support through weekly office hours, addressing common problem-solving challenges. Collaborated with the course instructor to identify learning hurdles and adapt teaching strategies, improving student comprehension and engagement.

University Program Assistant (Supervisor: Xinyu Zhang, Campus Programs Coordinator) 11/2024-Present
Student Worker (Campus Engagement Office) Kunshan, China

- Coordinated events including “Stage the World” and “Senior Banquet”, each attracts more than 200 participants. Overseeing logistics, scheduling, and communication between teams.
- Managed multiple tasks under pressure, ensuring smooth event execution. Developed skills in event planning, coordination, and problem-solving, with a focus on efficient communication and multitasking.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Chinese Mandarin (Native), English (Full Professional Proficiency, GRE 330)

Skills: Python, Java, {My, Postgres}SQL, Git, Excel, PowerPoint, Photoshop, After Effects, Premiere, Illustrator